

Executive Sales and Operating Performance Review, 2025-2026.

This update extends the original review through October 2026 and adds four new angles: channel-specific customer loyalty, inferred party size, tipping as a service-quality signal, and the effect of weather on buying behavior. The business is still absorbing a relocation, a price increase, and the loss of a nearby market — this report checks which parts of that story held, and which sharpened.

2025 FOOD SALES 7,344 tickets · \$5,097/day
REVENUE (JAN-SEP 2026) ▲ 4.6% vs. 2025
AVERAGE TICKET (JAN-SEP 2026) ▲ 12.4% vs. 2025
TICKETS (JAN-SEP 2026) ▼ 6.9% vs. 2025
DINE-IN TIP RATE (JAN-SEP 2026) 4.97% — down from 6.61% in 2025

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

PRICE ABSORBED, VOLUME STILL SOFT

Same Jan-Sep window: tickets are **-6.9%** and the average ticket is **+12.4%**, netting out to **+4.6%** total revenue. Both ticket metrics move in the same direction as the owner's own preliminary read (-10/-20% tickets, up to +35% ticket), but land more moderately — a real, verified correction to that estimate, not a contradiction of it.

DINE-IN KEEPS PULLING AWAY FROM TAKEOUT

The dine-in average ticket reached **\$317** in 2026 (from \$263), while takeout is flat at **\$238**. Dine-in now carries **61%** of revenue on **54%** of tickets.

SUNDAY, NOT "THE WEEKEND," IS THE REAL PEAK

Saturday has converged toward weekday levels; **Sunday alone** now outperforms the average weekday by over **+40%**. That lines up with the church next door, not generic weekend demand.

TIPPING RATE IS DOWN — A REAL SERVICE SIGNAL

Among dine-in tickets, the average tip fell from **6.61% to 4.97%** of the ticket, same window year over year. Worth a direct look, not just a data point.

RAIN MEASURABLY SOFTENS THE TICKET

Controlling for hour, month and year, the average ticket is about **12% lower** in rainy hours. Partial support for the "people duck in just for a drink" theory — real, but not as extreme as a single-drink ticket.

RENT REPRESENTS ~14% OF SALES

In the new, larger location — above the 6-10% reference range for the category.

Overall sales performance

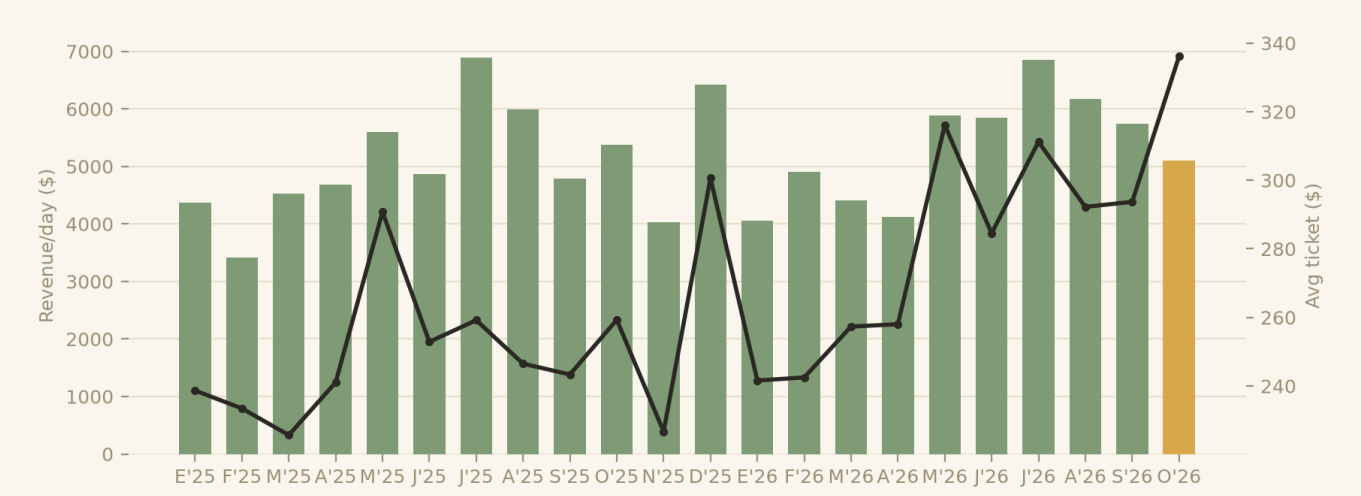
The business is sustaining revenue growth through price and channel mix, not through more customers walking in. That is a workable strategy for a transition year, but it has a ceiling: the comparison below shows a real, if more moderate than feared, decline in traffic.

Context behind the 2026 numbers

In November 2025, the six-block market located one block away from the restaurant was removed; from December onward, it stopped bringing people into the area. In January 2026, the business moved half a block to a larger location in front of the central park and next to the main church, while also applying a moderate price increase. Most of what the 2026 data shows — including the sharper Sunday pattern and the new findings in this update — is a consequence of these three changes landing at the same time.

Monthly trend: 22 months of operation

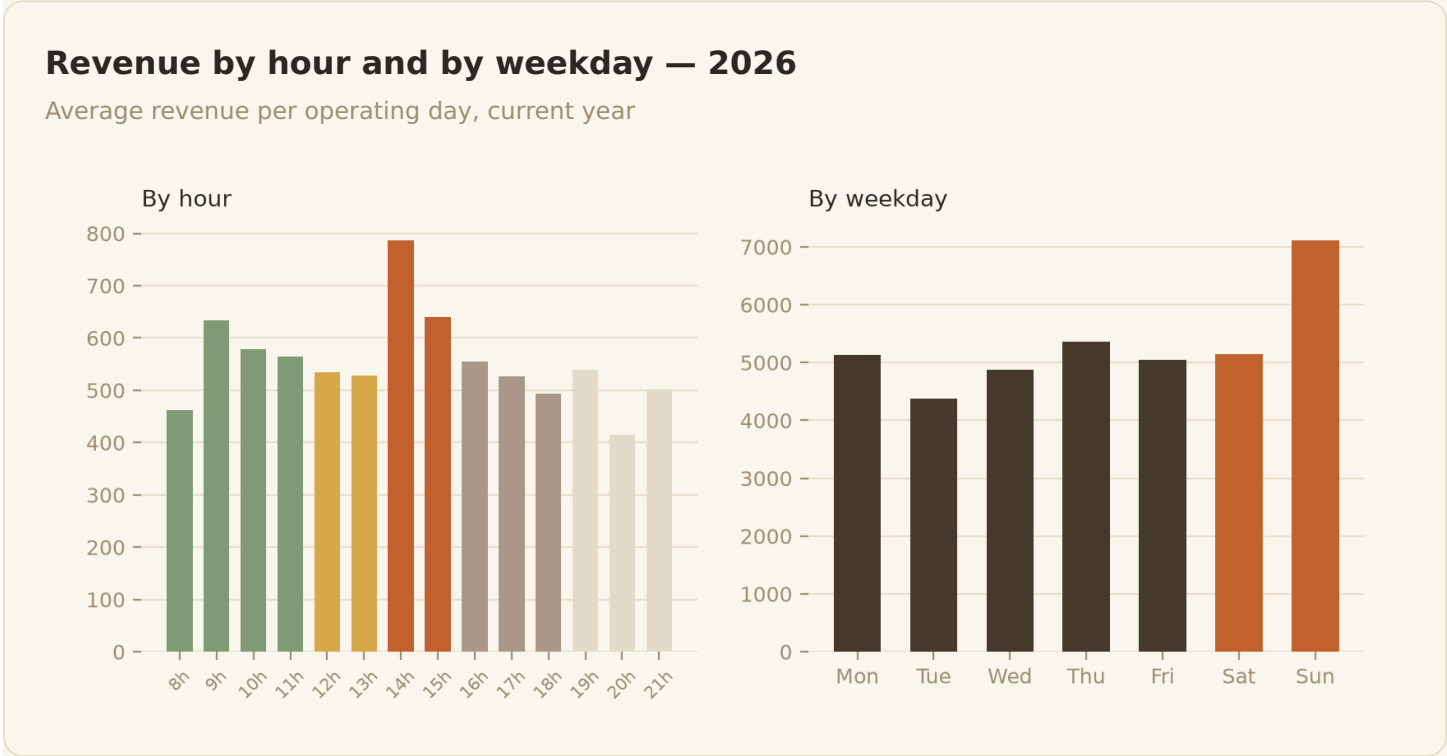
Green bars = average revenue per operating day · October 2026 (partial, 6 days) in amber · dark line = average ticket



Revenue per day across the full series. October 2026 is shown partial; the average-ticket line continues its 2026 climb from the May peak.

The revenue-per-day trend stays within a familiar band across both years — this is still a stable, seasonal business, not one in decline. The average ticket, however, has moved to a visibly higher plateau since the January 2026 price change, and has kept climbing through the year rather than settling back down.

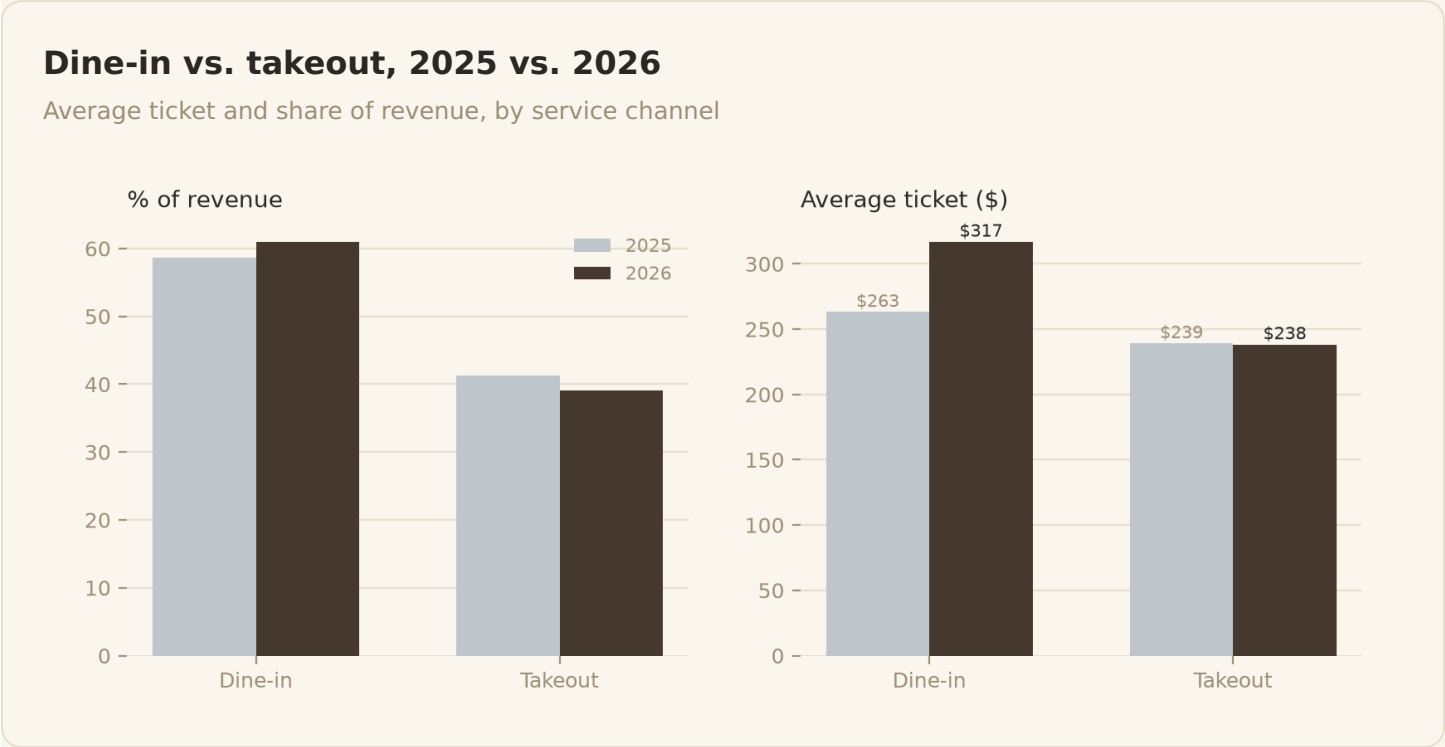
When does revenue come in now?



Still a breakfast-and-lunch business: it opens at 8h, climbs through the morning, and peaks at **14h**. Breakfast (8–11h) holds at **29%** of revenue, almost unchanged from before the move; the lunch block now carries **32%**, and evenings (18h+) have grown to **25%** of revenue — a larger share of the day than in the old location, consistent with the event room and the bigger dining room giving the evening more room to work.

The weekday pattern has changed in a specific way: **Saturday (\$5,145/day) has converged toward weekday levels** — barely above Monday or Friday — while **Sunday (\$7,107/day) stands clearly apart**, over 40% above the average weekday. The old "weekend premium" framing undersells what is actually happening: this is now a Sunday-and-church story, not a weekend story.

Dine-in vs. takeout: the gap keeps widening



Dine-in's average ticket grew **20%** (from \$263 to \$317) while takeout stayed essentially flat. Dine-in also gained revenue share (59%→61%) even though its share of tickets slipped slightly (56%→54%). Reading the two together: fewer, larger dine-in tickets are doing more of the work, and takeout is pure volume with little room left in its current form.

Who are the regulars? (aggregated only)

The POS only captures a customer name on **22.7% of takeout tickets** and **effectively never on dine-in tickets (0%)** — table service here simply does not collect that field today. So any "frequent customer" analysis can only really speak for the takeout channel; it is a genuine blind spot for dine-in, not evidence that dine-in lacks regulars.

43

FREQUENT TAKEOUT CUSTOMERS IDENTIFIED

~13

ORDERS EACH, OVER 93 WEEKS

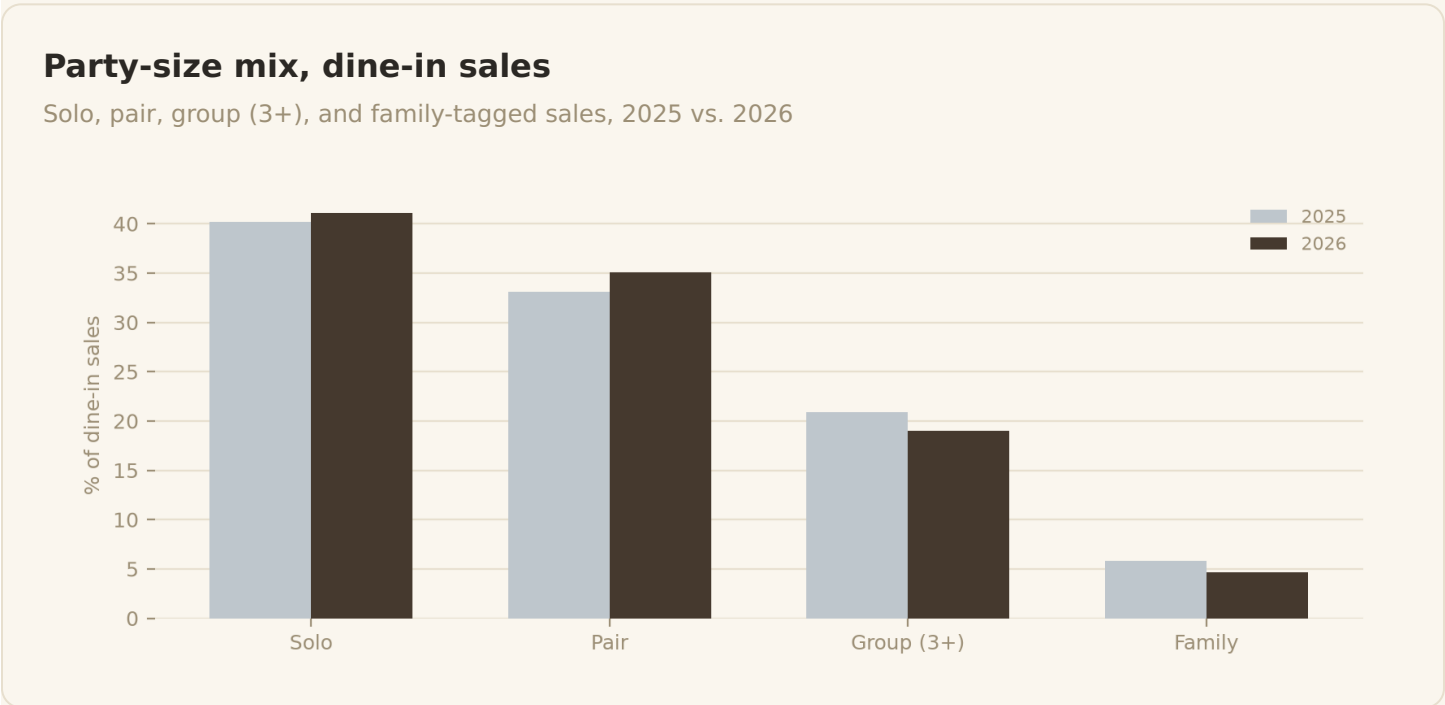
100%

OF THEM ARE TAKEOUT, BY DEFINITION OF THE DATA GAP

No names or identifiers are used anywhere in this report — only the aggregate counts above. Two concrete moves: (1) a simple stamp card for takeout, where the loyal base already exists and is currently getting nothing for its repeat business; (2) start capturing a name or phone number at the dine-in table too, even informally, so the next review of this kind can actually see that side of the business.

Who's at the table? (inferred)

Estimated from the dishes on each dine-in sale — not a headcount the POS captures reliably. A kids'-menu item on the ticket is read as a family order regardless of the dish count; otherwise the sale is bucketed by the number of main dishes ordered. This is a reasonable approximation for spotting patterns, not an exact count.

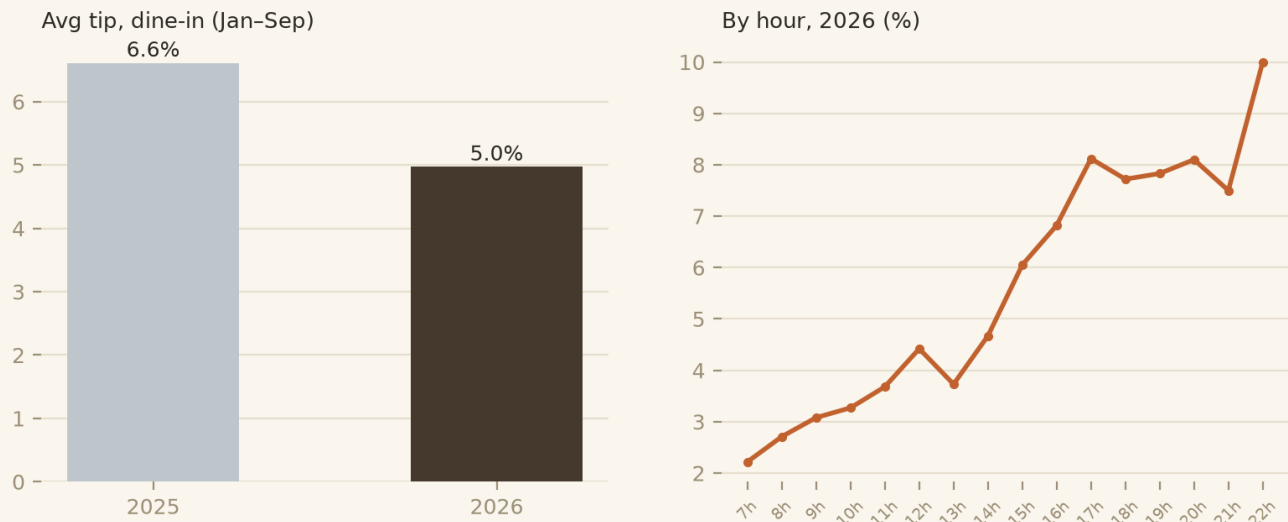


Solo diners are the single largest group at **41%** of dine-in sales — ahead of pairs (35%) and groups (19%). Family-tagged sales are a small slice (5%) overall, but **more than double that share on Sundays (7.2%)** — a direct, specific payoff of sitting next to the church. A fast, well-priced solo breakfast and a visible Sunday family package are the two clearest plays this data points to.

Tipping: a quiet signal worth watching

Tip rate, dine-in

Average tip as % of ticket, same Jan-Sep window both years, and by hour in 2026



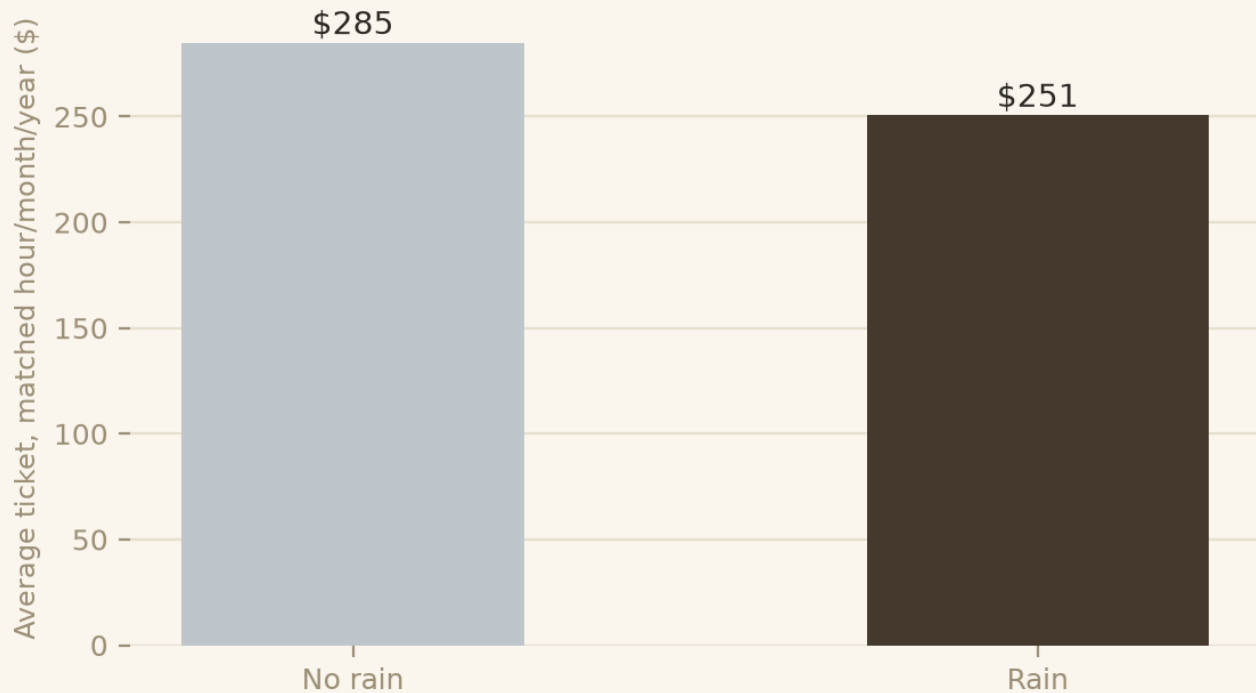
Only dine-in tips meaningfully — takeout essentially never does, which is expected and not a concern. Within dine-in, **53% of tickets** carry a recorded tip, and the average across all dine-in tickets (tipped or not) fell from **6.61% to 4.97%**, same months compared year over year. By hour, the rate climbs through the day and is lowest at opening (7-8h, under 3%) — worth checking whether that is a genuine early-service gap or simply smaller, lower-stakes tickets at that hour.

A larger dining room after the move can mean each server covers more tables; if that is what is happening, it would show up exactly like this — not in complaints, but in a quieter tip line. Worth a direct look at staffing ratios post-move before assuming it is something else.

Does weather change how people buy?

Average ticket, rain vs. no rain

Controlled for hour, month and year



Yes, measurably: the average ticket is about **12% lower** in rainy hours than in comparable dry hours at the same time of day. That is partial support for the idea that some rainy-hour customers are ducking in for less than a full meal — real, but the ticket doesn't collapse to a single-drink price, so it reads as "smaller orders," not "shelter-only" traffic. Strong heat alone shows a much weaker effect and isn't a reliable pattern on its own.

Implications of the new location

The relocation changed the cost structure and opened potential new revenue sources. The assessment of the new space should consider both rent pressure and the ability to generate complementary revenue.

Premises rent

~\$20-22k/month, equivalent to ~14% of food sales — above the common 6-10% reference range. Justified only if the larger space earns revenue the old location could not.

Sublease & event room

The beverage/ice-cream sublease (~\$2k/month) already covers ~10% of rent with no operational effort. The event room is the highest-potential, highest-margin piece and should be activated and tracked as its own revenue line.

Diagnosis

Strengths

- Revenue growth held through a double transition (market loss + relocation)
- Real pricing power: +12.4% ticket, accepted by customers
- Dine-in getting more valuable every quarter (\$317 avg.)
- A genuine Sunday franchise next to the church
- A loyal, identifiable takeout base (43 regulars) ready for a loyalty program

To monitor

- Tickets still down 6.9% — volume hasn't turned the corner
- Dine-in tip rate down a third, same window — a service-quality flag
- Saturday no longer outperforms weekdays — it's Sunday doing the work
- Dine-in customer identity is a complete blind spot (0% captured)

Risk

- Growth cannot keep coming from price alone — that path has a ceiling
- Rent at ~14% of sales pressures margin if the event room stays unused
- A quietly declining tip rate can compound into real churn before it is visible in sales

Recommendations

1. Develop the event room as a formal revenue line.

Because: rent is ~14% of sales and the event room is the piece that justifies the larger location.

2. Launch a stamp card for the 43 identified takeout regulars.

Because: they already exist and are currently getting no recognition for repeat business.

3. Build a visible Sunday family offer.

Because: family-tagged sales are more than double their usual share on Sundays, next to the church.

4. Check staffing and service pacing in the dine-in room directly.

Because: the tip rate fell by a third in the same window, a quieter signal than a complaint but a real one.

5. Start capturing a name or phone number at the table, not just at the counter.

Because: dine-in loyalty is currently invisible to the business (0% coverage) — it isn't that there are no regulars, it's that nobody is recorded.

6. Recover traffic rather than raising prices again.

Because: the average ticket already absorbed one increase; the lever that hasn't been pulled is volume.

7. Protect and grow breakfast, and test a fast solo-breakfast combo.

Because: breakfast is still 29% of revenue, and solo diners are the single largest party-size group.

8. Increase the takeout average ticket with a suggested add-on at order time.

Because: takeout ticket is flat at \$238 while dine-in has grown 20%.

9. Plan staffing and inventory around the real seasonal curve, not the calendar year.

Because: July–August and December remain the clear peaks across both years of data.

Source: point-of-sale exports (VENTAS_2025.xls and VENTAS_ANUAL_2026.xlsx, through Oct 6, 2026) and hourly weather data (Open-Meteo reanalysis, same coordinates). Valid sale = Estado "Cerrada" and Total > 0; the Creación (creation) timestamp is used throughout, not Cerrada (closing), since closing time can be affected by batch administrative closures. Year-over-year comparisons use the same Jan–Sep window in both years. Party size is inferred from main-dish line items per sale, not a captured headcount — an approximation, stated as such throughout. Frequent customers are identified only where the POS records a customer name (10.1% of tickets overall) and reported only as aggregate counts. Currency is Mexican pesos (MXN). Analysis in Python (pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib).